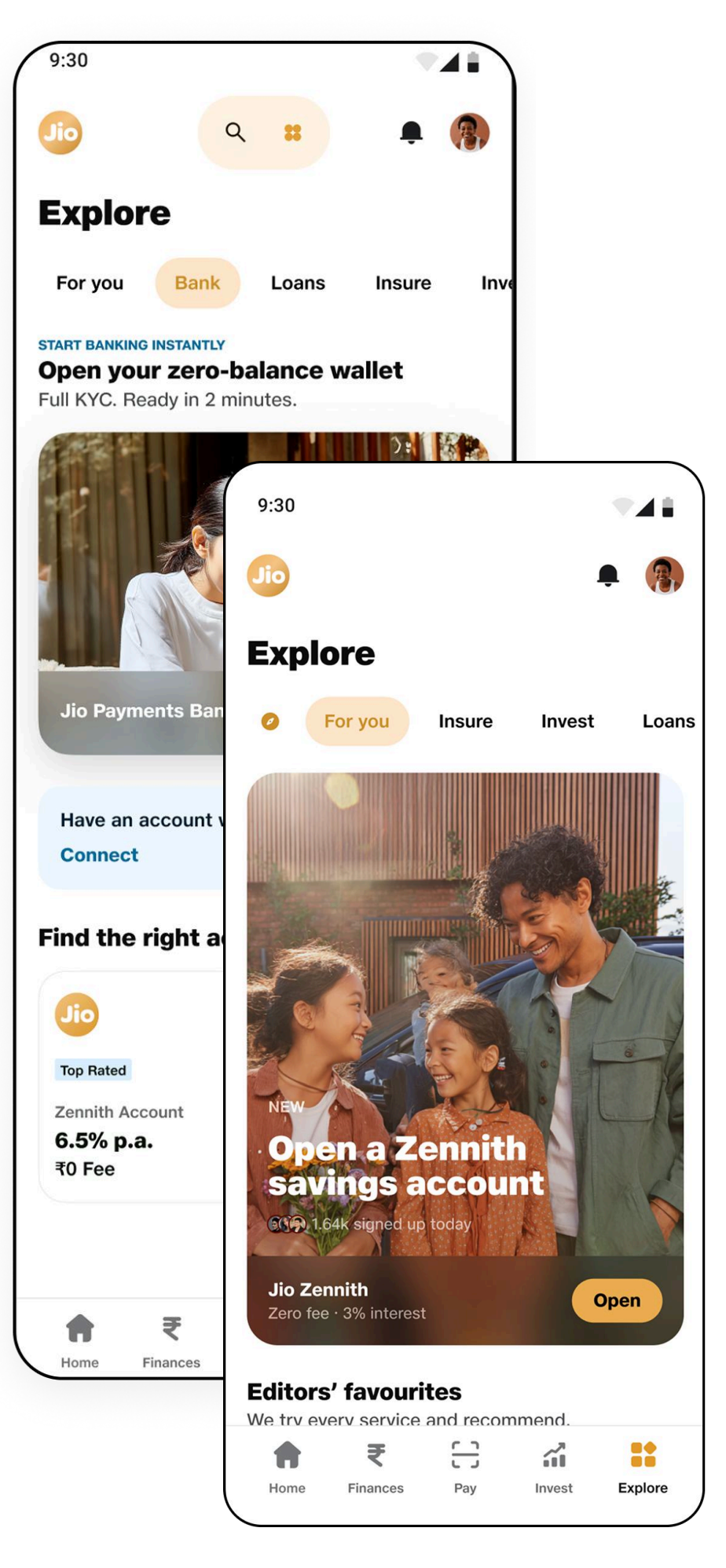
**JioFinance**
**UX Research**



## JioFinance

How I researched fear, trust, and hesitation in high-stakes financial flows and turned behavioral insights into UX guidelines for the Jio Design System.

3 fear categories identified

3 severity levels tested

DS guidelines adopted

**Context**

Financial apps ask users to take high-stakes, irreversible actions. Most UX guidelines weren't built for that.

JioFinance - covering payments, loans, insurance, UPI, and investments — needed UX guidance specific to flows where mistakes have real financial consequences.

**01 / Context**

JioFinance was in beta — covering payments, loans, insurance, UPI, and investments. Every key user action had real financial consequences.

**02 / The gap**

Existing DS guidelines covered standard UI patterns — but had no specific guidance for destructive actions in high-stakes financial flows where mistakes can't be undone.

**03 / The question**

What makes users hesitate, panic, or abandon a financial action — and what UX patterns can reduce fear while maintaining appropriate caution?

## Design Process

**Beta Version**
Beta Version is available for internal users

**Foundation Research**
Fear + trust psychology in destructive action flows 3 stages of user testing"

**Feature Evaluation**
Mapped 9 feature areas: Pay, Invest, Cards, Loans, Insurance, UPI, Bank, Plans, Support

**User Experience Audit**
Evaluated against 10 Jio experience principles across all core journeys

**In - App Journey Audit**
Find the In-App broken journeys and Evaluating JFS on Jio's 10 experience principles.

**UI Review**
DS compliance audit tokens, components, and interaction standards

**Version 1**
UI Audit according to Jio Design System STD

## Foundation Research

JioFinance users face actions with real financial consequences a mistaken transaction, an accidental loan confirmation, an irreversible account change. I ran a 3-stage research programme to understand what triggers fear and hesitation, and what UX patterns reduce it without removing appropriate caution.

## Primary Objective

- Identify fear points in user decision-making during important actions
- Analyze the psychological triggers of fear
- Evaluate existing mitigation strategies
- Measure user trust and confidence levels
- Develop UX principles to reduce fear

**Outcome**

UX guidelines for destructive action interfaces adopted into the Jio Design System as the standard for high, medium, and low severity flows

## Research Methodology

**Research**

- Secondary research and Design — Stage 1: Understand destructive actions, and subsequently designing screens for testing with the users
- 1:1 In-Depth user Interview — Stage 2: Observe user behavior and hesitation across three Jio app flows with varying levels of destructive actions.
- Analysis — Stage 3: Observe users as they interact with screens highlighting destructive actions

Usability testing sessions with users to understand the fears, triggers and perceptions around destructive actions.

## Secondary Research

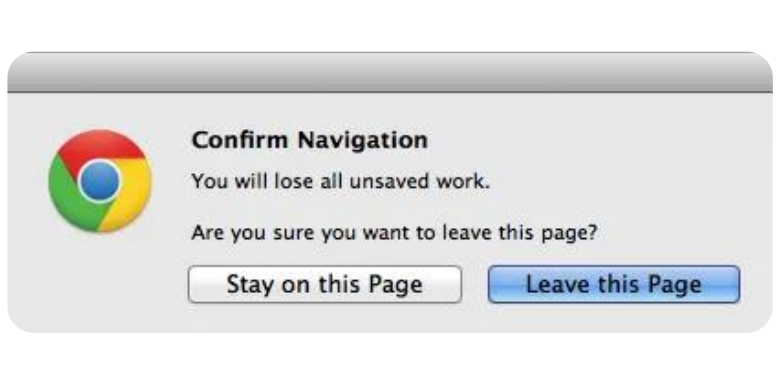
**Types of Decision**

There are 2 layers of decisions which users can encounter :
1. Severity of decision ( High, Medium, Low )
2. Positive or negative decision

**Types of actions**

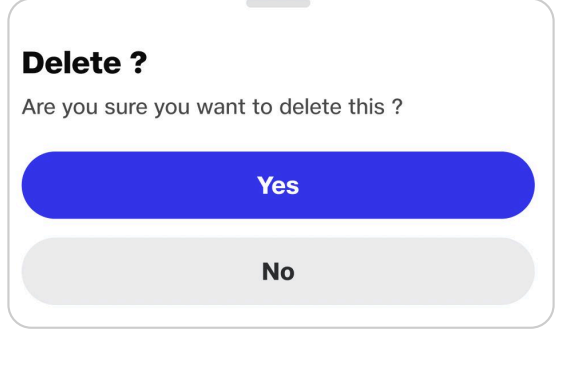
There are 2 types of destructive actions:

1. Affirmative destructive actions: Destructive actions initiated by the user that takes the users further in their journey (for example, Save or Delete)
2. Accidental destructive actions: Destructive action aren't always affirmative. In certain cases, destructive actions might be initiated accidentally by the user or by the system.



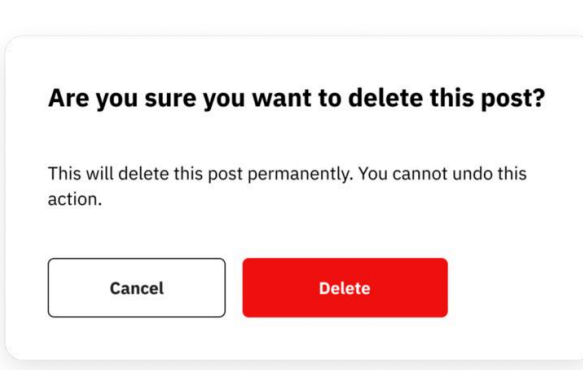
Confirm Navigation
You will lose all unsaved work.
Are you sure you want to leave this page?
Stay on this Page
Leave this Page

Accidental triggers



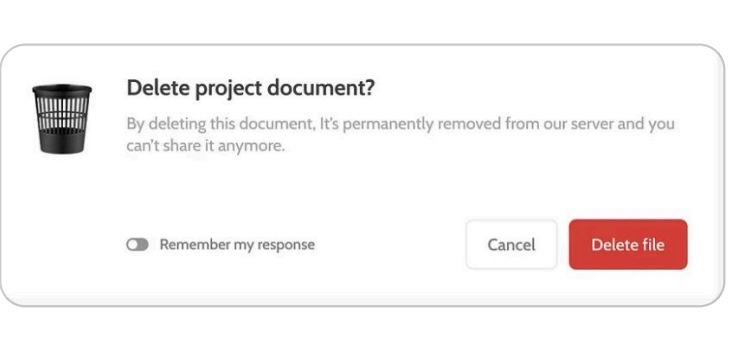
Delete ?
Are you sure you want to delete this ?
Yes
No

Ambiguous triggers



Are you sure you want to delete this post?
This will delete this post permanently. You cannot undo this action.
Cancel
Delete

Affirmative actions



Delete project document?
By deleting this document, it's permanently removed from our server and you can't share it anymore.
Remember my response
Cancel
Delete file

Irreversible outcomes

## Fears which exist

### Accidental triggers

Users accidentally navigate away from a page without saving data — or accidentally initiate an action they didn't intend. Triggered by ambiguous back buttons, swipe gestures, and unclear CTAs.

Design response: Confirmation step + explicit undo option before any data loss occurs.

### Ambiguous Actions

Users are uncertain about the impact, outcome, or reversibility of their decision. "What happens after I tap this?" is the unspoken question on most financial confirmation screens.

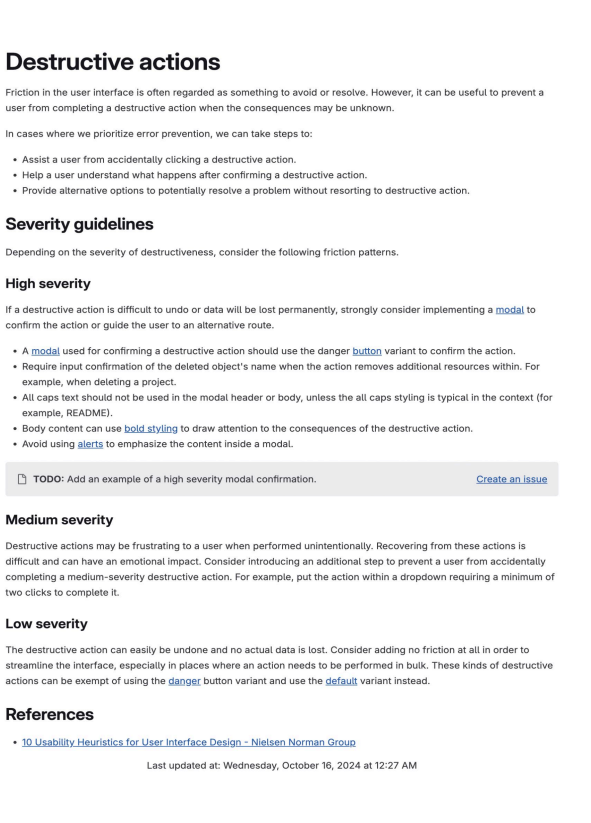
Design response: Intent-based copy + clear consequence description before the action is taken.

### Irreversible outcomes

Actions that lead to permanent consequences that cannot be undone — a completed transfer, a closed account, a confirmed loan. These cause panic when users feel underprepared.

Design response: Progressive disclosure of consequences + explicit "this cannot be undone" signal at the right moment.

GITLAB DS



Destructive actions

Friction in the user interface is often regarded as something to avoid or resolve. However, it can be useful to prevent a user from completing a destructive action when the consequences may be unknown.

In cases where we prioritize error prevention, we can take steps to:

- Assist a user from accidentally clicking a destructive action.
- Help a user understand what happens after confirming a destructive action.
- Provide alternative options to potentially resolve a problem without resorting to destructive action.

Severity guidelines

Depending on the severity of destructiveness, consider the following friction patterns.

High severity

If a destructive action is difficult to undo or data will be lost permanently, strongly consider implementing a modal to confirm the action or guide the user to an alternative route.

- A modal used for confirming a destructive action should use the danger button variant to confirm the action.
- Require input confirmation of the deleted object's name when the action removes additional resources within. For example, when deleting a project.
- All caps text should not be used in the modal header or body, unless the all caps styling is typical in the context (for example, README).
- Body content can use bold styling to draw attention to the consequences of the destructive action.
- Avoid using alerts to emphasize the content inside a modal.

TODO: Add an example of a high severity modal confirmation. Create an issue

Medium severity

Destructive actions may be frustrating to a user when performed unintentionally. Recovering from these actions is difficult and can have an emotional impact. Consider introducing an additional step to prevent a user from accidentally completing a medium-severity destructive action. For example, put the action within a dropdown requiring a minimum of two clicks to complete it.

Low severity

The destructive action can easily be undone and no actual data is lost. Consider adding no friction at all in order to streamline the interface, especially in places where an action needs to be performed in bulk. These kinds of destructive actions can be exempt of using the danger button variant and use the default variant instead.

References

- 10 Usability Heuristics for User Interface Design - Nielsen Norman Group

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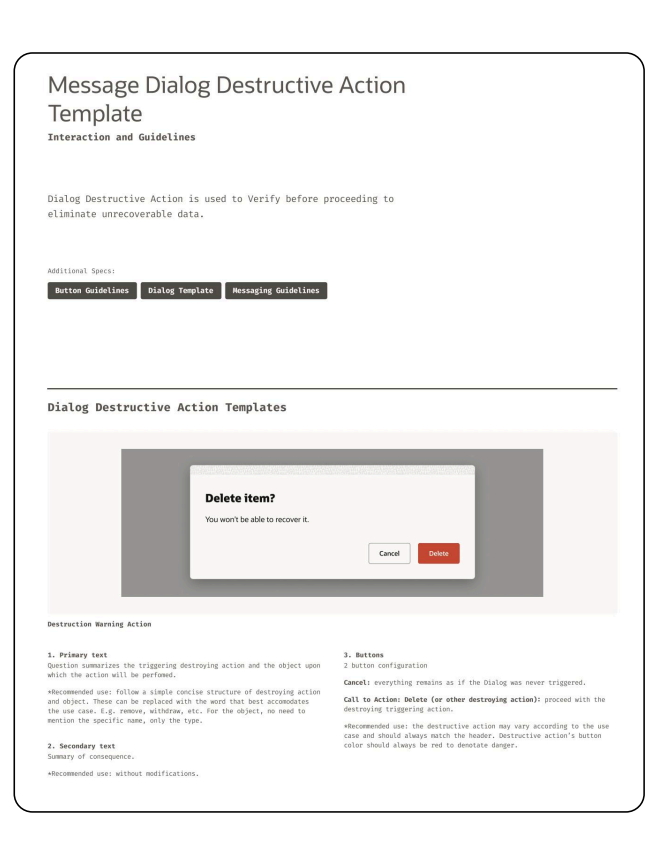
Oracle



Message Dialog Destructive Action Template
Interaction and Guidelines

Dialog Destructive Action is used to Verify before proceeding to eliminate unrecoverable data.

Additional Specs:
Button Guidelines
Dialog Template
Messaging Guidelines

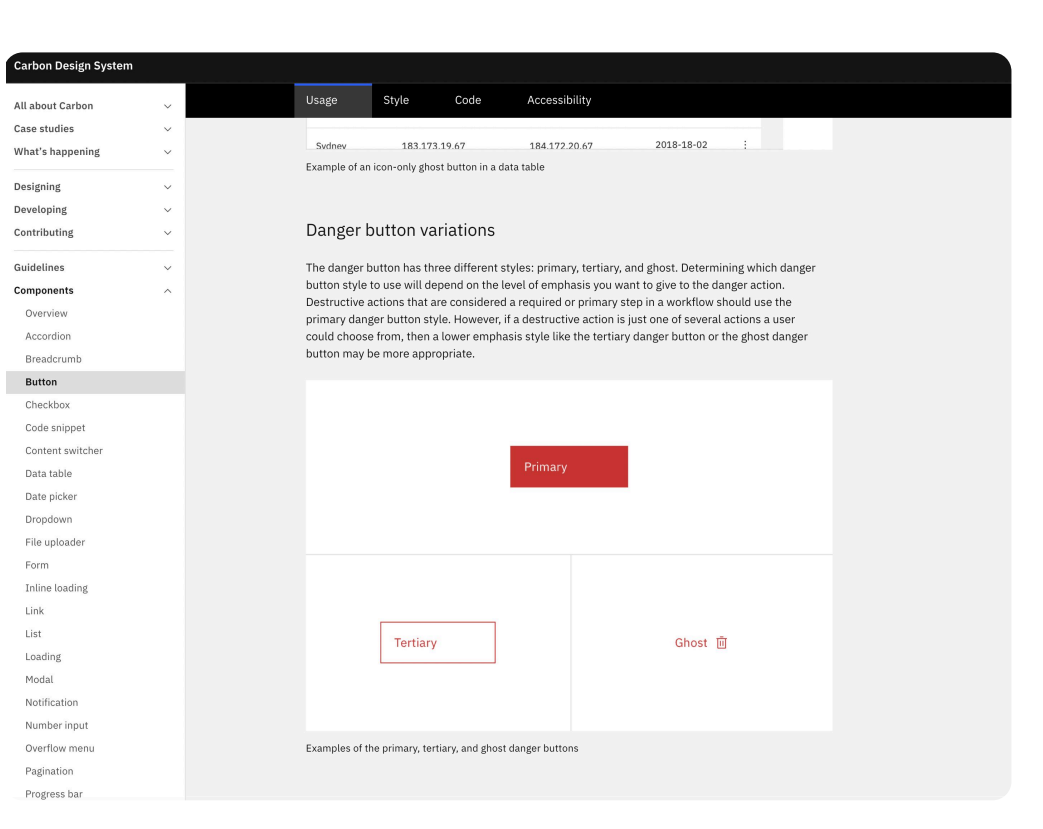
Dialog Destructive Action Templates

Delete item?
You won't be able to recover it.
Cancel
Delete

Destruction Warning Action

1. Primary text
2. Secondary text
Summary of consequence.
3. Buttons
2 button configuration

Carbon DS



Carbon Design System

Usage
Style
Code
Accessibility

Danger button variations

The danger button has three different styles: primary, tertiary, and ghost. Determining which danger button style to use will depend on the level of emphasis you want to give to the danger action. Destructive actions that are considered a required or primary step in a workflow should use the primary danger button style. However, if a destructive action is just one of several actions a user could choose from, then a lower emphasis style like the tertiary danger button or the ghost danger button may be more appropriate.

Primary
Tertiary
Ghost

Examples of the primary, tertiary, and ghost danger buttons

**Summary**
**GITLAB DS**
Takeaway: Appropriate friction prevents accidental actions. Applied this to define when a confirmation step is necessary vs. when it creates unnecessary anxiety.

**Summary**
**Oracle DS**
Takeaway: Intent-based button labelling reduces hesitation. Applied to JioFinance CTAs — e.g. 'Confirm transfer of ₹500' instead of generic 'Confirm

**Summary**
**Carbon DS**
Takeaway: Visual distinctiveness (red, spacing, modals) for irreversible actions. Used to define the visual treatment for high-severity flows in JioFinance

## Secondary Research

Linking

## Primary Research

### What

Types of Destructive Actions:
Defined affirmative vs. accidental actions.

User Fears & Pain Points:
Identified major concerns: accidental triggers, ambiguous actions, irreversible outcomes.

Severity Levels Framework:
GitLab, Oracle, and Carbon DS emphasize clear hierarchy, warnings, and confirmations, leading to a structured low, medium, high severity approach

### Why

Insights from GitLab, Oracle, and Carbon DS emphasise severity-based handling—this framework helps apply those best practices systematically. So the screens were tested on basis of hierarchy

Assess User Impact:
Some actions (e.g., deleting an account) have irreversible consequences, while others (e.g., removing an item from a cart) can be undone. Severity helps differentiate these cases.
Clear severity levels prevent overuse of warnings, ensuring users only pause when truly necessary.
High severity : JioFinance, Low severity : Deleting address and Medium severity : E-commerce order cancellation

## Primary Research

**Testing for Primary research**

The primary research aimed to understand user hesitation and fear while performing destructive actions in Jio apps.

**Approach:**

User Testing: Observing interactions with destructive actions like completing transaction in JioFinance app, Deleting address, and cancellation of Order in Jiomart

## Confidential

Key observations from primary testing:
· Users spent 3–5x longer on screens with ambiguous CTA copy vs. intent-based copy
· 7 out of 10 participants verbally expressed uncertainty before confirming a transaction
· Irreversible outcome screens without explicit consequence statements caused visible hesitation in all participants
· Progressive disclosure of consequences reduced reported anxiety significantly

## Next Step -

**JioFinance Research**

- User Testing — Testing the role of UX copy
  - High Severity Flow design
  - Medium Severity Flow design
  - Low Severity Flow design
- Painpoints
- Opportunities
- Proposed Guidelines

We can connect further to know in detail.

## Feature Evaluation

Feature and Functionality: What the Marketplace Section Offers

Personalisation journey
Plan Loans Invest Cards
Pay Bank and UPI
Support & Guidance
Insurance

## Experience Evaluation

Consumer Engagement
Confidence Joy Simplicity
Clarity Convenience
Re-engagement Visibility
Sense of Control Personal Connection

## Next Step

**Feature Evaluation**
Evaluating what features needed and the use.

**User Experience Audit**
Evaluating user experience while using the app.

**In - App Journey Audit**
Find the In-App broken journeys and Evaluating JFS on Jio's 10 experience principles.

**UI Review**
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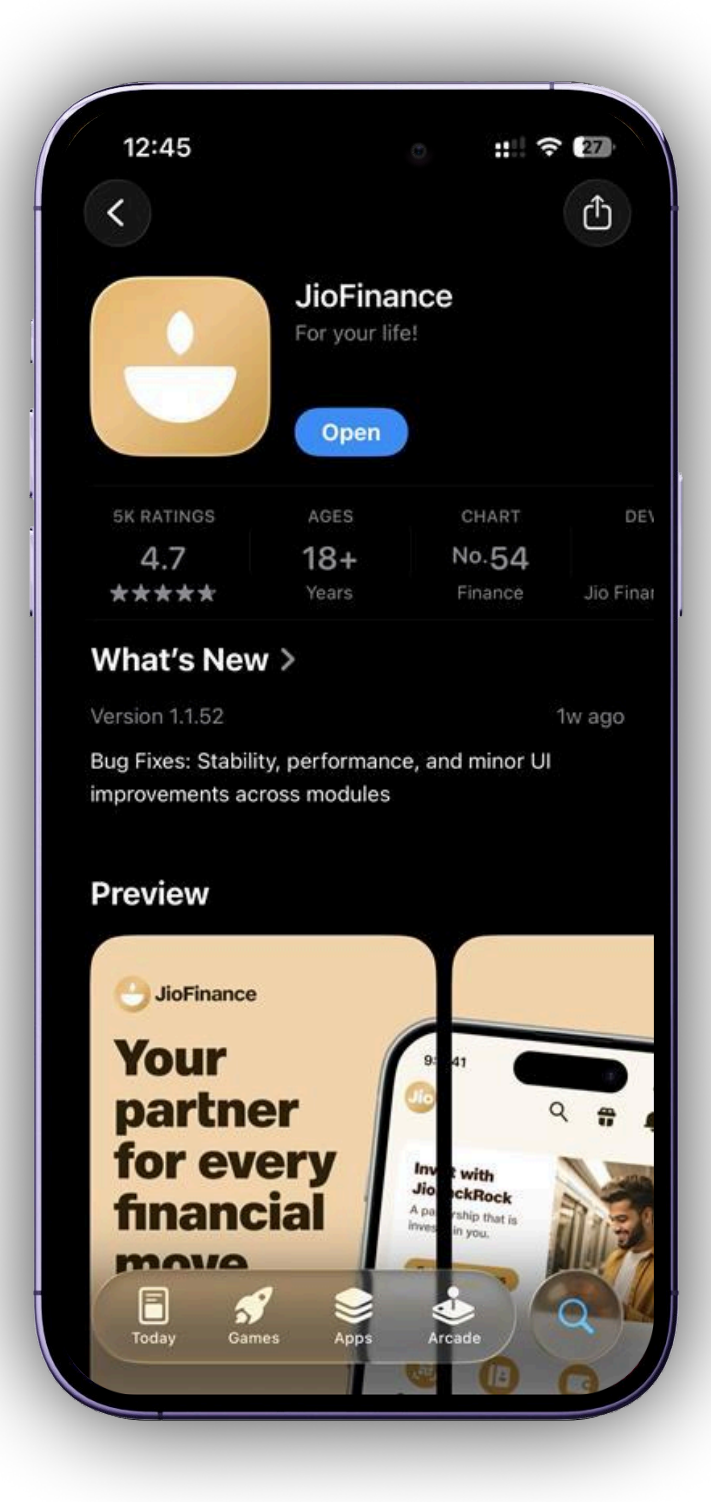
JioFinance



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JioFinance
For your life!
Open
5K RATINGS 4.7 ★★★★★
AGES 18+ Years
CHART No.54 Finance
What's New
Version 1.1.52 1w ago
Bug Fixes: Stability, performance, and minor UI improvements across modules
Preview
Your partner for every financial move

# Let's talk about how I can bring this to your team.

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